



HOMWORK 4: GOALS

What are Goals?

Goals are statements that define what your church will accomplish after your **MARKETING PLAN** has been implemented.

Goals are S.M.A.R.T.

Specific - A specific goal has a greater chance of being accomplished than a general goal. To get specific, the goal should state who is involved, what will be accomplished, where (if applicable), by when it will be accomplished and why – how it works toward the vision.

Measurable – Quantifies success and progress toward it. To measure, ask questions like - How much? How many? How will I know when it is accomplished?

Attainable – You want to set your goals high enough to challenge your thinking, creativity and move you farther along, but you also don't want to get discouraged. Set goals that will inspire you and where you can celebrate small steps along the way.

Realistic – Set your goals within the reality of your current context and resources. Don't establish goals that would have you reaching for people you don't have access to or accomplishing things your church is not able to do.

Timely - A goal should be grounded within a time frame. With no time frame tied to it there's no sense of urgency and no one is held accountable.

Example

Background: *To help model our church's vision of cross-generational church participation, our Jr. High class will be in charge of promoting and running the UMC Annual Senior Citizen's Fish Fry at Memorial Park. Teens are expected to properly market the event, organize the work/volunteer schedule, order food and supplies, prepare, cook and clean-up after the event.*

Strategic Objective – *Help model our church's vision of cross-generational church participation.*

Goals – *Involve at least 15 teens to organize UMC Annual Senior Citizen's Fish Fry at Memorial Park. The event should draw at least 50 senior citizens. Raise \$500 through this initiative.*

Measurable Goals – *How many teens participated? How many senior citizens were served? How many other people attended the event? What word-of-mouth feedback did the teens receive about the event? How much money was raised? What was the interaction between the generations?*

How do Goals impact your MARKETING PLAN?

They help you define success so you know when you get there.

Example:

A church with a vision for connecting young adults to Christ might develop a Marketing Plan Strategy that invests resources toward reaching college students. Their goal might be to increase the number of college students who attend their Sunday night service by 50% within six months. They know that after nine months, if the result is a 50% or more increase, their strategy has been successful.

They set you on a plan to measure results so you can ensure what you are doing is worth the time and energy. If not, you can alter approaches until desired results are achieved.

Example:

In the example above, the church will know the number of college students before implementing strategies. Then they'll come up with ways to track those numbers (attendance cards, counting heads, tickets) along the way, and at the end of the nine months, they do the math. If there has been a 50% increase, they celebrate then set a new goal. If not, they analyze what of their strategy has worked and what they need to modify.

Evaluate and coach people

Example:

In the example above, staff and lay leaders will be evaluated and coached based on how they invest their time toward college students.

Respond



Based on what you have read about goals, answer the following:

What kind of "successes" do you hope to see your **MARKETING PLAN** accomplish?

Based on your church's Values/Vision, what is important to you? What should you measure, thus placing value and importance on?

With everything you've learned so far about your church and community, what would be some BAG: Big, Audacious Goals your church could set that would really challenge you to make an impact.
